

Octacore mobile CPU

ARM has announced Cortex A15 for mobile devices. It features 8 cores and achieves speeds of up to 2.5 GHz

Windows Phone 7

Microsoft's much awaited smartphone OS, Windows Phone 7 is set to launch in October

Bazaar

ASUS NX90Jq

The Goliath yells, "Lend me your ears!"



Specifications

Intel Core i7 720QM, Windows 7 Ultimate, 4 GB DDR3 RAM, 18.4-inch display, Nvidia GeForce GT335M

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Price: ₹1,30,999

7.0/10

Features.....	7.5
Performance.....	7.5
Build Quality.....	8
Value for money.....	5.5

When we first laid eyes on the ASUS NX90, we were taken aback by the sheer size of the laptop that lay in front of us. The mirror finish, reflective enough to stop anyone in their tracks and make them look is a one of a kind concept seen in any laptop these days. Then again, pretty much every design aspect of this laptop sets it apart from what the lay man's definition of a laptop would be.

One of two laptops in the NX90 series, the ASUS NX90Jq has dimensions that pretty much nullify its portability. The polished aluminum exterior gives

it a mirror like appearance and is very aesthetically pleasing but it's a fingerprint magnet and 15 mins of handling the laptop is all it took to tarnish its pristine exterior.

It's vibrant 18.4-inch screen with a 16:9 aspect ratio is a Full HD (1920x1080) LED backlit display. The audio solution selected features speakers by Bang & Olufsen ICEpower. Two uniquely positioned speakers on either side of the screen have been placed as far apart as possible to help improve resonance and sound quality. The speakers sounded exceptionally breathtaking when compared to any other laptop. This is by far one of the best performing audio solutions we have come across on any laptop. The vertical towers project the audio at ear level.

Yet another first, this laptop features two trackpads. Placed on either side of the keyboard instead of the usual up front and centre arrangement, the trackpads initially took a lot of getting used to and were annoyingly inconvenient at first. Each individual trackpad features multi touch support (pinch to zoom), along with ASUS's nifty two finger scrolling capability but the trackpad usage was not as smooth as we hoped.

ASUS could have easily incorporated a numberpad which is missing thanks to the extra trackpad. The keyboard itself is not very nice to use and lacks a tactile feel, though the open space under the keyboard serves as a good palm rest while typing.

Since the laptop has been built for home entertainment and not for office use, the graphics solution, NVIDIA GeForce GT335M (1 GB DDR3) leaves something to be desired if you plan on playing the latest games.

When looking around the laptop at the available ports, the standard set of interfaces were seen along with some new improvements such as 2 USB 3.0 ports and 1 e-SATA combo port.

As expected, the NX90 fared very well on all the benchmarks such as PCMark Vantage, SiSoft Sandra and Maxxon CineBench. Doom 3 showed a frame rate of 187.6 fps. Battery life clocked in at almost 3 hours and it lasted 2 hrs in our multimedia tests.

It will set you back by ₹1,30,999 which suggests that it is a product meant for the niche market and not for someone looking for a common multimedia laptop. It is a solid performer with its minor shortcomings but could be your pride and joy should you have some money lying around.

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